

Panasonic HD (6752.T): Group CFO/operating company CEO meetings: Forming structure to win with competitive generative AI products; Buy

On July 31, we held meetings with (1) the CEOs of Panasonic Energy and Panasonic Industry (CEO Kazuo Tadanobu and CEO Masato Ozawa), and (2) Group CFO Akira Waniko as a follow-up to [1Q3/26 earnings](#).

The most important point is that, in addition to ongoing business portfolio transformation, **the entire holding company is beginning to work on strengthening its competitiveness in AI-related products, which continue to see strong demand at present.** Historically, despite having products with a first-mover advantage in terms of technological and product capabilities, the complexity of being a conglomerate has to an extent, hindered the company from making focused and timely investments, thereby allowing some competitors to gain ground. According to the CFO, the internal mindset is changing, and we think **the key focus will be on whether the company can execute a strategy focused on winning in battery backup units (BBUs), capacitors, and multi-layer circuit board materials (CCL, MEGTRON) for generative AI.** In BBUs, the company will strengthen its competitiveness through the in-house production of battery cells and the new product capacitor backup units (CBUs). For MEGTRON, the company will proceed with capacity expansion and utilize its flexible production lines to further raise the mix of high value-added products.

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Key points from the CFO meeting

Transition from structural reform to growth mode

- The company said that the internal mindset is changing. It is moving away from the traditional, less focused conglomerate structure.
- MEGTRON is a symbolic example of where supply capacity expansion did not happen in time, and as a result, the gap with Taiwanese competitors has become apparent in recent years. Securing manufacturing capacity is important for hyperscalers, and the company is currently in internal discussions regarding further investments for capacity expansion to capture market share. It will disclose details as decisions are made.
- In addition to discussions on the final shape of the business portfolio (structural reforms), discussions on business growth are also becoming more active.

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Full-year guidance

Forex: The company has made conservative assumptions from 2Q. In the event of yen depreciation, there could be upside, mainly in Panasonic Industry and Panasonic Energy.

Tariff refunds: The accounting structure is complex. The company recorded a provision for FY3/26 automotive tariffs, which were split 50/50 with customers, but this is set to be reversed. The amount was ¥7 bn in 1Q, but there is also a possibility that, for example, refunds of over ¥10 bn could suddenly be received in a certain quarter.

HVAC & CC business (reasons for weak profit growth despite higher sales in 1Q)

The main cause is a pullback from high-margin environmental engineering projects in FY3/26. In addition, amid strong demand in Japan (last-minute demand before energy-saving regulations) and Asia, pricing/promotions were somewhat inefficient. This will be corrected from 2Q onward, according to the company. While A2W is primarily a heating system, it can also be used for cooling by adding a cooling unit, expanding business opportunities due to the severe heat in Europe.

Electric Works business (background to upward revision)

The company made progress with price hikes that exceeded the pass-through of cost increases, backed by its strong position in domestic electrical construction materials.

Key points from the Panasonic Energy/Panasonic Industry CEO meetings**Panasonic Industry****Multi-layer circuit board materials (CCL, MEGTRON)**

- Meg9 mass production timing: The company is currently producing small volumes for customer verification, with full-scale mass production to begin from FY3/28.
- Shift to high-performance products: The production ratios of MEGTRON 6 and below and MEGTRON 7 and above (high-performance) are currently about half and half. However, the high-performance weighting is targeted to reach about 60% in FY3/27, and the company plans to further raise the ratio from FY3/28. The production lines are shared and can be flexibly switched according to orders.
- Capacity expansion investment: In addition to Guangzhou, Suzhou, and Ayutthaya, additional expansions are under internal discussion. The company expects to make announcements in due course.
- MEGTRON adoption is expanding in the semiconductor testing area, in addition to motherboards/substrates.

Conductive capacitors

- SP-CAP is performing well in semiconductor peripherals, and POSCAP has a market share of around 80% in backup applications for SSDs.
- Prices of tantalum and rare metals are rising, but customers have also accepted price revisions.

FA solutions

- Around 30% of sales are for semiconductor production equipment. Japan, Taiwan, South Korea, and China are the main markets, and the company has an order backlog of more than six months.

Panasonic Energy (AI-related)

Rubin generation: Mass production of new capacity cells for Rubin has already partially begun (shipments starting in June-July), and they are being adopted early. The company believes it can largely maintain an 80% market share even in the Rubin generation. The design for Rubin is complete, and Rubin Ultra is also in its final stages.

Sales growth: Module sales will not simply increase 1.5X along with rack power consumption increasing from 130 kW to 200 kW, but will rise on a value basis due to shelf integration and value-added features. Growth close to the capacity increase serves as a guideline, according to the company.

In-house production: BMSs are almost entirely produced in-house, and the company is strengthening its production system by preparing for partial in-house production of DC/DC converters as well.

CBU: Visibility has improved compared to before. The company said it sees upside room for sales.

Customer expansion: The company has won almost all BBU orders. With the addition of CBUs, it also expects to expand its new customer base.

Panasonic Energy (automotive-related)

Background to delayed Kansas launch: There were operational challenges (securing personnel and proficiency levels). As a result, the company could not fully respond to actual demand.

Gap between 1Q automotive loss (c.¥15 bn excluding IRA subsidies) vs. annual loss (over ¥70 bn): The main factor is the impact of tariffs (c.¥30 bn annually, conservatively assumed from 2Q onward on the assumption of no refunds).

Investment Thesis - Panasonic Holdings

Panasonic Holdings has a broad range of businesses, including home appliances, automotive batteries, industrial equipment, automotive equipment, and e-components. While its traditional core businesses have been home appliances (accounting for 30-40% of sales and profits), automotive batteries supplied mainly to Tesla, and Blue Yonder, which became a wholly owned subsidiary in 2021, attention has recently shifted to products for data centers, such as BBUs, CCLs, and high-performance capacitors. We believe the profit contribution from generative AI-related products will rise to around 20% on an EBITDA basis in FY3/27. In addition, with benefits from structural reforms and a peak in investment in automotive batteries and Blue Yonder, we believe strong cash flow will be generated, potentially resulting in large-scale share buybacks. We are Buy rated.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Panasonic Holdings

We are Buy rated. Our 12-month target price is ¥5,100. We apply an EV/EBITDA multiple of 9.0X (FY3/28E base year, based on the historical correlation between EV/EBITDA and

EBITDA margin). Risks: **Companywide:** (1) Weaker-than-expected progress with fixed-cost reductions or insufficiently realized benefits from business reforms across the company as a whole, (2) weaker growth prospects due to the loss of key personnel during the fixed-cost reduction process, (3) slower-than-expected progress in revamping the business portfolio as a result of delays selecting buyers, (4) additional investment and depreciation burdens arising due to increased demand for cylindrical batteries, and (5) forex trends (we estimate that every ¥1 appreciation vs. the USD/EUR/CNY impacts annual adjusted operating profits by -¥0.9 bn/-¥1.0 bn/+¥4.7 bn, respectively). **Lifestyle updates business:** Weaker demand for residential/commercial air conditioners due to a downturn in the global economy, or the loss of market share to more popular or cheaper products at competitors. **Panasonic Connect:** (1) A slump in the company's aircraft services business if the "bring your own devices" trend were to become more common for in-flight entertainment on commercial aircraft, (2) weaker-than-expected sales growth at acquired company Blue Yonder (standalone basis), (3) major impairment losses on Blue Yonder if the calculation of its present value were to require a higher WACC due to rising interest rates, softer demand or other factors (indication of impairment is checked every quarter), and (4) a longer-than-anticipated decline in demand for various mounting systems used in process automation, such as the manufacture of PCs and smartphones. **Panasonic Energy:** Tesla opting to increase its use of batteries made by other companies, leading to stronger pricing pressures, a further slowdown in the EV market, or increased competition in the generative AI-related battery backup unit (BBU) business. **Panasonic Industry:** Weaker-than-expected factory automation-related demand, stiffer competition in the generative AI-related hybrid capacitor and circuit board material businesses, or a longer-than-expected downturn in demand for smartphones and other consumer electronics.

6752.T

12m Price Target: **¥5,100**Price: **¥3,584**Upside: **42.3%****Buy****GS Forecast**

Market cap: ¥8.4tr / \$52.5bn
 Enterprise value: ¥9.0tr / \$56.3bn
 3m ADTV: ¥50.1bn / \$311.9mn
 Japan
 Japan Industrial Electronics
 M&A Rank: 3
 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?:
 Yes

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥ bn)	8,048.7	7,907.8	8,545.5	9,230.4
Op. profit (¥ bn)	236.4	607.0	831.4	1,049.4
Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	290.0	590.0	—	—
EPS (¥)	81.2	213.3	290.3	375.2
P/E (X)	22.5	16.8	12.3	9.6
P/B (X)	0.8	1.5	1.4	1.2
Dividend yield (%)	2.2	1.5	2.0	2.5
N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	1.3	0.4	0.1	(0.2)
CROCI (%)	8.1	9.2	11.1	13.7
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)	57.9	48.1	52.7	50.6

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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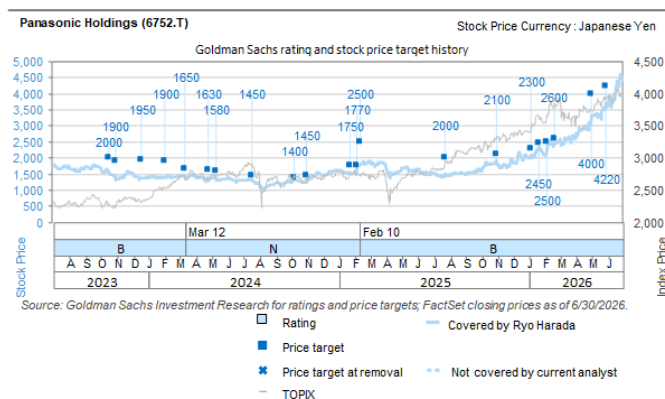
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Panasonic Holdings (6752.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
30-Jul-26	5,100	3,584
07-Jul-26	5,000	4,400
29-May-26	4,220	3,700
30-Apr-26	4,000	3,203
19-Feb-26	2,600	2,525
04-Feb-26	2,500	2,194
19-Jan-26	2,450	2,351
05-Jan-26	2,300	2,079
30-Oct-25	2,100	1,924
23-Jul-25	2,000	1,506
10-Feb-25	2,500	1,784
04-Feb-25	1,770	1,530
23-Jan-25	1,750	1,548
31-Oct-24	1,450	1,238
07-Oct-24	1,400	1,318
18-Jul-24	1,450	1,318
09-May-24	1,580	1,387
24-Apr-24	1,630	1,393
12-Mar-24	1,650	1,394
02-Feb-24	1,900	1,383
19-Dec-23	1,950	1,370
30-Oct-23	1,900	1,437
17-Oct-23	2,000	1,585

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